CARBON INSIGHT BRIEF - 02

Verra's CCS Methodology Receives ICVCM Approval: A Milestone for Integrity

Stronger integrity for CCS credits, and a clearer choice for the market



Taqi Hammam Ariza | November 2026
taqihammam@gmail.com

KEY POINTS

- Verra's carbon capture and storage methodology, **VM0049**, has been approved by the Integrity Council for the Voluntary Carbon Market (ICVCM) as meeting the **Core Carbon Principles**.
- The approval covers VM0049 and its modules for direct air capture, CO2 transport, CO2 storage and bioenergy with CCS (BECCS).
- The methodology has been active since June 2024. What is new is the independent integrity endorsement, including a rule that renewable electricity claimed by a project must come from new sources built for it.
- A recognised benchmark can strengthen the integrity of CCS credits and support more CCS in the future, and the market can now decide how to use it.

Carbon capture and storage is no longer only an industrial decarbonisation tool. It is steadily becoming a recognised part of the voluntary carbon market, and that market has just given CCS a significant vote of confidence.

In late September 2026, Verra announced that its carbon capture and storage methodology, VM0049, had been approved by the Integrity Council for the Voluntary Carbon Market (ICVCM) as meeting the Core Carbon Principles (CCPs) [1]. What follows covers the basics, what is new, and what the approval means for the market.

1. The basics: Verra, the ICVCM and the CCP label

Verra is one of the world's leading carbon crediting standards. Its Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) program sets the rules that projects follow to generate carbon credits [1].

The ICVCM is an independent body that sets a global benchmark for high-integrity carbon credits, known as the Core Carbon Principles. Credits that meet it can carry a "CCP label", designed to help buyers identify credits that meet rigorous quality standards [6].

The label works in two steps. The ICVCM assesses the crediting program first, then the specific methodologies used to generate credits. Only credits from a CCP-Eligible program and a CCP-Approved methodology can carry the label [4]. Verra's VCS Version 5 was recognised as CCP-Eligible on 2 September 2026 [4], so with VM0049 now approved, both steps are in place for credits generated under it. The ICVCM does not carry out project-level assessments [6].

VM0049 is Verra's framework for projects that capture CO2 and store it permanently in geological formations. It was developed by the CCS+ Initiative, South Pole and Perspectives Climate Group with support from Verra, and it has been active since June 2024 [2], [5].

2. What's new

The methodology has existed for over two years. What is new is the independent endorsement: VM0049 was already a published, operational framework, and it has now passed the ICVCM's integrity assessment [1].

The approval covers VM0049 together with its modules, which address each stage of a CCS project: VMD0056 for direct air capture, VMD0057 for CO2 transport, VMD0058 for CO2 storage and VMD0059 for bioenergy with carbon capture and storage (BECCS) [3]. This modular design lets developers combine capture, transport and storage approaches to suit their projects, and it accommodates shared pipelines and storage sites as well as new technologies as they emerge [1].

The approval also reflects the methodology's rigour on energy use. Capturing carbon takes energy, and VM0049 sets a clear standard for it: where projects rely on renewable electricity, that electricity must come from new sources developed specifically for the CCS project, not from existing renewable generation [1]. In practice, the clean power a project claims is power that was added for it.

3. What it means

The most important effect of this approval is on integrity. CCS credits generated under VM0049 can now be measured against a recognised quality benchmark in the voluntary carbon market. CCS projects are complex and require significant infrastructure and capital, so a clear, independently assessed methodology helps developers measure their climate benefits and gives buyers a common framework for evaluating the resulting credits [3].

That clarity matters because CCS projects take time and investment to build. A methodology with a recognised integrity label can make it easier for projects to plan around carbon credit revenue and for buyers to engage with them. In that way, stronger integrity today can help open the way for more CCS in the future.

From here, the market decides. The CCP label gives buyers a credible reference point, and they remain free to look at the projects behind the credits, including storage sites, monitoring and energy sourcing. The label complements project-level due diligence rather than replacing it, and it gives the market another methodology that has passed an independent integrity assessment [3].

4. Key takeaways

Three things stand out for those working in or around CCS:

- **For project developers.** VM0049's modular structure and energy-use requirements can be built into project design from the start. A CCP-approved methodology gives a project a recognised integrity foundation.
- **For buyers and investors.** Check both steps, the CCP-eligible program and the CCP-approved methodology, then continue with the usual project-level review [4].
- **For the wider CCS community.** Independent recognition of this kind is a sign of the technology's maturing role in climate markets, and it shows that CCS can meet demanding integrity standards.

CCS is increasingly judged not only on what it can capture, but on how credibly that capture is measured and verified. With this approval, that credibility has taken a clear step forward.

References

[1] Verra. (2026, September 28). *Verra secures ICVCM approval for carbon capture and storage methodology* [Press release]. https://verra.org/verra-secures-icvcm-approval-for-carbon-capture-and-storage-methodology/

[2] Carbon Herald. (2026). *ICVCM greenlights Verra's carbon capture methodology*. https://carbonherald.com/icvcm-greenlights-verras-carbon-capture-methodology/

[3] CarbonCredits.com. (2026). *Verra CCS methodology gets ICVCM approval as carbon removal market grows*. https://carboncredits.com/?p=48157

[4] CarbonCredits.com. (2026). *Verra wins ICVCM approval for VCS Version 5 as carbon market integrity tightens*. https://carboncredits.com/?p=47375

[5] Verra. (n.d.). *VM0049 Carbon Capture and Storage, v1.0*. https://verra.org/methodologies/vm0049-carbon-capture-and-storage/

[6] SustainCert. (n.d.). *What you need to know about the ICVCM and the first carbon credits with Core Carbon Principle labels*. https://sustain-cert.com/news/what-you-need-to-know-about-the-icvcm-and-the-first-carbon-credits-with-core-carbon-principle-labels